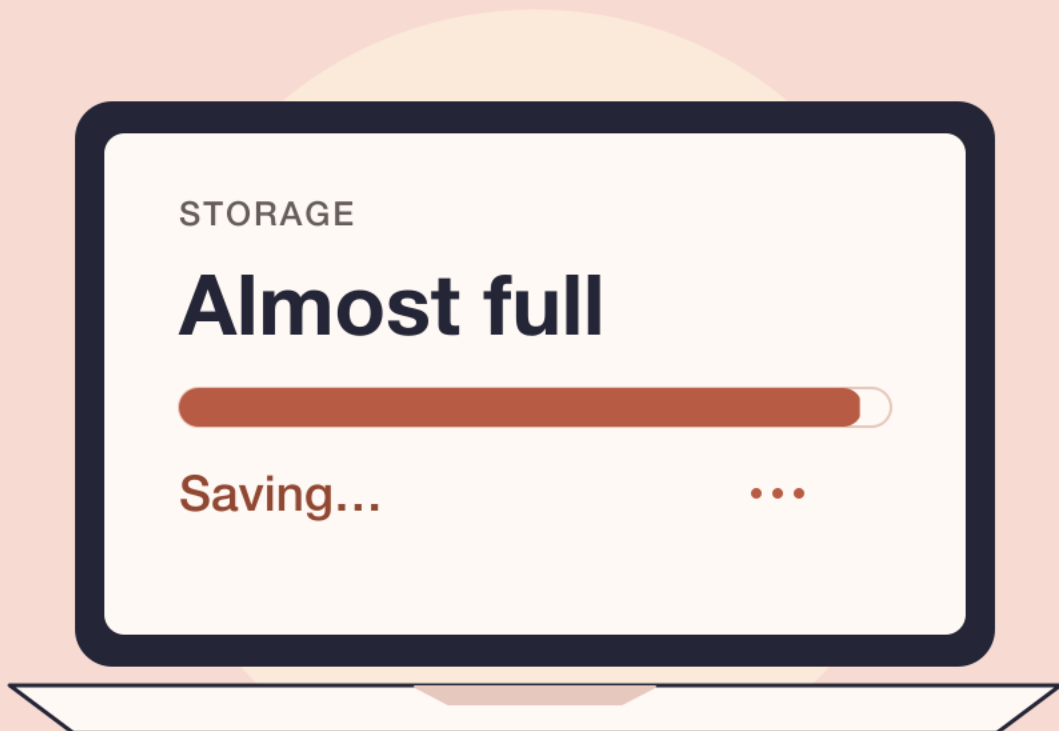


Storage almost full. Why so slow?

Your files are only part of the story.
Your computer needs room to work.



See why space matters.

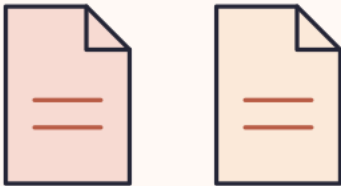
THE IDEA MOST PEOPLE MISS

Storage is also working space.

Photos and videos live there.

So do files your apps create while working.

YOUR SAVED FILES



Things you keep

TEMPORARY WORK



Room to get things done

Filling the drive leaves less space
for that behind-the-scenes work.

An update needs more than its download.

It may need room to unpack files, install the new version and recover if it fails.

ONE UPDATE / SEVERAL JOBS



Download



Unpack

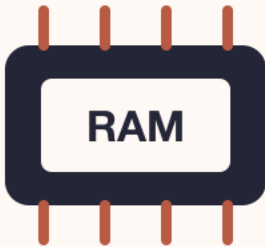


Install

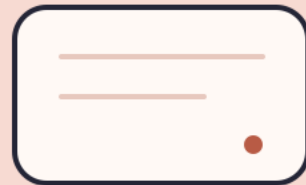
With too little room, the job may stall or fail. Saving and exporting can too.

RAM and storage do different jobs.

RAM is fast memory for work happening now.
Storage keeps files for longer.



RAM / the desk

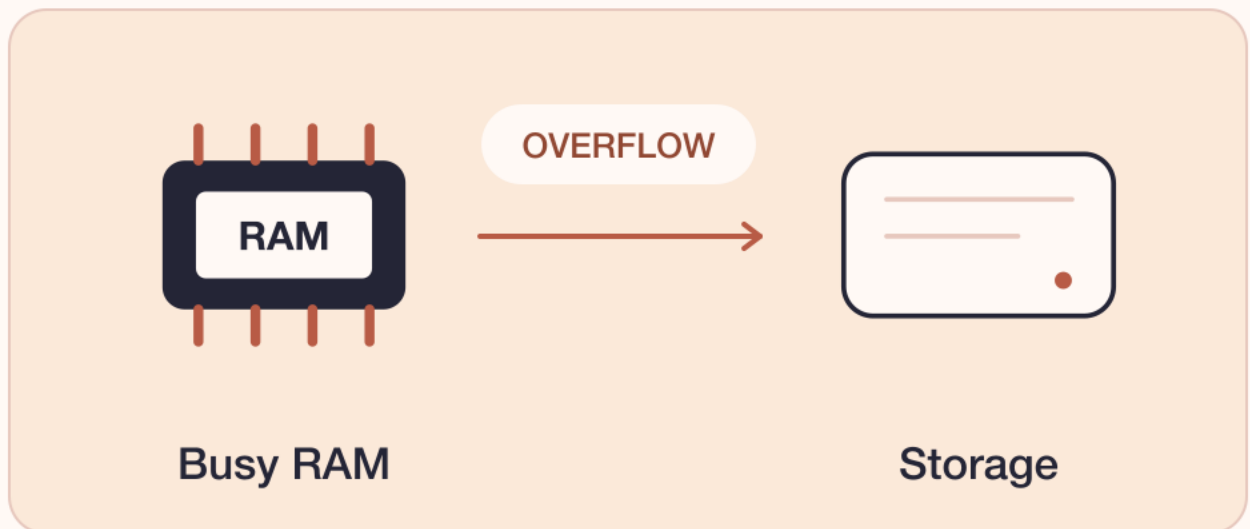


Storage / the cupboard

Freeing storage creates more room there.
It does not give you extra RAM.

Some work can spill onto storage.

The system can move less-active data there.
Windows uses a page file for this.
A Mac uses swap files.



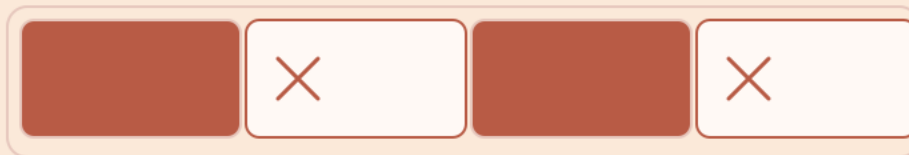
That is slower than using RAM.
The overflow file also needs disk space.

This happens under memory pressure, not just a full drive.

An SSD cannot just overwrite old data.

An SSD is the storage inside most laptops. It writes small pieces, but erases in groups.

ONE GROUP / CALLED A BLOCK



 Still needed

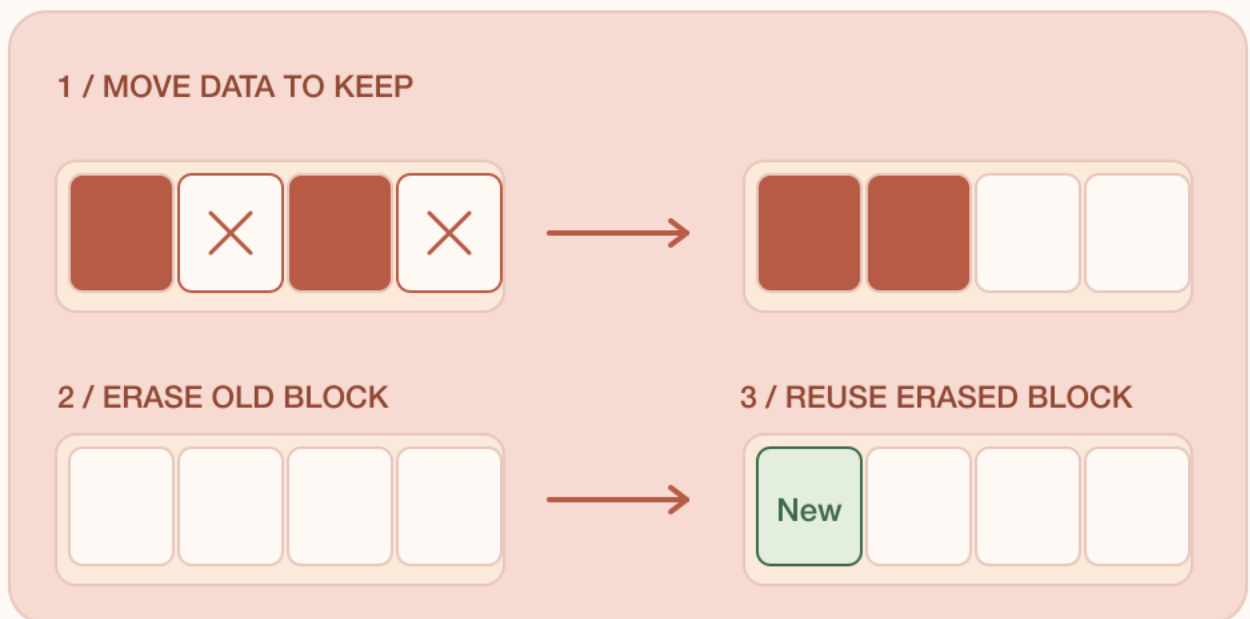
 No longer needed

A deleted piece does not automatically make the whole group ready to reuse.

HERE IS THE EXTRA WORK

Move. Erase. Then write.

Before reusing a partly occupied block,
the SSD may need to do this:



**With fewer free blocks, new writes can
involve more of this reshuffling.**

Simplified illustration. The effect depends on the SSD and workload.

SO HOW MUCH SPACE IS ENOUGH?

There is no magic percentage.

A large update or video export can need much more room than everyday browsing.

LEAVE ROOM FOR YOUR NEXT JOB



Your files

Working room

Illustration, not a recommended percentage.

Act before low-space warnings.

Write-heavy tasks may be affected most.

It does not automatically slow every read or processor task.

Make room. Keep what matters.

- ✓ Open your built-in Storage settings.
- ✓ Review large files and unused apps.
- ✓ Back up important files before removing.
- ✓ Review Trash before emptying it.

Use the system's cleanup recommendations.

Mac: System Settings → General → Storage

Windows: Settings → System → Storage

Free space is working room.

01 Temporary files need it.

02 Memory overflow may need it.

03 SSD writes can benefit from it.

Space helps the computer get things done.

Still slow? Check busy apps and memory pressure too. Storage is only one cause.